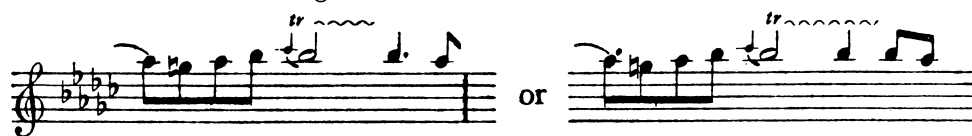


PRELUDE VIII

THE chords marked with the arpeggio-sign are so marked by Bach himself, and should be broadly spread, with plenty of singing tone on the top note. Other chords throughout this Prelude may also be slightly broken. The sign ω throughout is best interpreted by an ordinary long trill, beginning (according to rule) with the upper note and running straight into the following semiquavers. In bar 19 this shake may begin by making a heavy *appoggiatura* of the upper note and then shaking until the next beat, or even until the last crotchet, thus:



In any case, notice that the crotchet after the dotted minim will become a quaver, so as to chime with the prevalent dotted crotchets. (It is better for students of Bach to learn such cases so as to be able to apply them on principle elsewhere, than to trust to a modernised notation which represents the facts crudely and with a false precision.)

The shake in bar 24 should have a final turn; that in bar 15 should run straight into the following note; that in bar 28 stops on the dot, and the ω in bar 36 is quite short. The *appoggiatura* in bar 36 is in this edition noted as a crotchet, that being its best real value here. Some of the best MSS. do not give it.

The *tempo* is fixed within narrow limits, on the one hand by the details in bars 12-14, which should fall naturally into their place without need for noticeable slackening, and on the other hand by the minim chords which should not lose their swing as grouped in triple time. Within their firm frame-work the declamation should be free and impulsive, the longer notes giving rise to the semiquavers as if in the same breath. A good test for the naturalness of the rhythm is given in bar 18 by the fact that, if the two semiquavers in the treble are lightly delivered, no desire will be felt to read $F\flat$ instead of Bach's $F\sharp$; though, meanwhile, the bass will be asserting $F\flat$ strongly and (as suits the clavichord) broadening in its declamation as it gets lower.

In bars 31-35 the clavichord has powers of *crescendo* quite as effective as anything the pianoforte can do here.

FUGUE VIII

THIS Fugue is occupied entirely with its Subject, direct and inverted, partially and wholly augmented, and combined in various Stretti. There is no Countersubject, and the Episodes are mere undifferentiated breathing-spaces between the Stretti. There is thus no other theme to bring out besides the Subject. The phrasing of the Subject demands constant attention in

A.B. 99.

all entries, directed and inverted. On no account must the third and fourth crotchet of the second bar seem to echo the first two crotchets. The resulting tautology, already annoying in the Subject, would be intolerable in the Answer and in the Inverted Subject. The first seven beats of the theme must be one *legato* phrase ending on the D $\sharp$, and the rest a fresh clause. In the First Stretto Bach has, by way of an afterthought, accentuated this point by improving the counterpoint with quaver rests.

The shake on the penultimate note is not in Bach's handwriting, but was inserted into one of the autographs by a pupil. Any player in Bach's lifetime would have supplied it without prompting, and with the full approval of the composer. It should be adopted and applied to the inverted as well as the Direct Subject wherever technically convenient (*e.g.*, bar 32). The bracketed shake in bar 40 is in no old manuscript or edition, but is absolutely necessary, and to omit it would be a solecism. In bar 16 the two suggestions added above the stave represent what Bach would certainly have written if his clavichord (at the date of the First Book) had gone beyond C $\sharp$. In bars 20-21, 41, 73-74, our Kirnberger-Altnikol readings, inserted also by correction into one of the autographs, are to be unhesitatingly preferred. No mere theorist ever effected such improvements in a Fugue that has always attracted the special attention of theorists, but has attracted it on grounds with which these obviously fine readings have nothing to do.

This Fugue will be more easily memorised if notice is taken of the plan of its ten Stretti. Stretto 1, concerning the middle and treble voices, at half a bar in the octave, is found in bars 19-22. In Stretto 2 (bars 24-26) the Subject in the treble is answered at a crotchet's distance by the middle voice in the lower fifth with a peculiar semi-augmentation, the bass adding a hint of a third entry extraneous to the scheme. Stretto 3 (bars 27-29) is Stretto 1 inverted in Double Counterpoint in the twelfth (this being a prominent feature in this Fugue), so that the answer is in the lower fifth instead of the upper octave. After this series of two-part Stretti comes the Exposition of the Inverted Subject in all three parts; treble (bars 30-32), middle (bars 36-38), and bass (bars 39-41; note the characteristic semiquaver flourish by which it brings itself into position). Then comes a new pair of Stretti, beginning with Stretto 4 (bars 44-47), which applies Stretto 1 to the Inverted Subject, and Stretto 5 (bars 47-50), which likewise inverts Stretto 2 with its semi-augmentation. Then the three-part Stretti begin; Stretto 6 (bars 52-53) with the Direct Subject at one and two crotchets in one and two octaves, bodily inverted in Stretto 7 (bars 54-55). A single entry of the Direct Subject (lightly imitated in the bass) intervenes in bars 57-60, leading to an emphatic half-close (bar 61); whereupon arises the first of the Augmented Stretti. Stretto 8 (bars 61-66) answers the Subject (in the middle voice) by the full Augmentation in the bass at half-a-bar's distance. As the Augmentation naturally takes twice as long as the Subject, there is room for another answer during its latter part; and the treble accordingly adds the Inverted Subject to the combination. Stretto 9 (bars 67-72) inverts the two lower parts of Stretto 8 in the twelfth, and this time the treble adds the Direct Subject. The tenth and last Stretto (bars 77-82) combines the three versions of the Direct Subject (normal, semi-augmented, and fully augmented) at one and two crotchets and one and two octaves, the middle voice adding another entry of the normal subject to the latter part.

The *tempo* is accurately fixed by the necessity of getting bar 11 clear without allowing the whole composition to drag.